

GL VERIFIER

GLOBAL CASES LIBRARY

Nine Countries · Nine Diagnostic Reports · Nine Remediation Plans

Library Reference Format: GL Diagnostic Report v1.0 Each case in this library follows the GL Verifier Standard Diagnostic Report format: **Section 1: Executive Summary · Section 2: GL Scoring · Section 3: Citizen Objective · Section 4: Friction Findings · Section 5: Failure Patterns · Section 6: Structural Weakness · Section 7: Core Insight · Section 8: Remediation Recommendations · Section 9: Conclusion**

GFI Flow Intelligence

By Ping Xu · gfiintel.com · 2026

Global Cases Reference Table

All nine cases evaluated using the GL Formula: Legitimacy (GL) = (Flow Success Rate × Strategic Value) ÷ (Pain Duration × Cognitive Friction)

Case ID	Country / Policy	Key Failure	GL Score	Projected GL	Risk
GL-US-001	USA / Loan Forgiveness	Compliance firewall, burden transfer	0.006	≈2.91	Critical Risk
GL-UK-001	UK / Universal Credit	Chronic attrition, 5-week survival gap	0.06	≈0.68	Critical Risk
GL-TW-001	Taiwan / Vaccine Booking	Digital divide, elderly exclusion	0.16*	≈2.55	High Risk
GL-IN-001	India / Demonetization	Denominator catastrophe, zero transition	0.023	≈0.19	Critical Risk
GL-EU-001	EU / GDPR	Consent fatigue, SME burden	≈0.40	≈3.61	High Risk
GL-JP-001	Japan / MyNumber	Trust deficit, value opacity	0.15*	≈5.76	High Risk
GL-ZA-001	South Africa / SASSA	Volatility, single point of failure	0.066-0.71	≈2.14	Critical Risk
GL-AU-001	Australia / Flood Relief	Disaster blindness, prove-crisis paradox	0.078	≈6.21	Critical Risk
GL-CA-001	Canada / Passports	Foreseeable crisis, time expectation collapse	0.032	≈1.06	Critical Risk

* Denotes the most vulnerable cohort GL score, not overall GL. See individual case report for full analysis.

GL < 0.5 = Policy Violence Zone · GL 0.5–1.0 = Marginal · GL 1.0–2.0 = Acceptable · GL > 2.0 = High Integrity

GL-US-001 United States · Higher Education / Debt Relief

United States: Public Service Loan Forgiveness (PSLF)

Section 1 — Executive Summary

Case ID	GL-US-001
Country / Region	United States
Policy Evaluated	Public Service Loan Forgiveness (PSLF)
Policy Domain	Higher Education / Debt Relief
Period of Analysis	2007–present
GL Index Score	0.006
Risk Classification	Critical Risk
Key Structural Weakness	The system was designed for lawyers, not borrowers. Eligibility rules were retroactively changed, employer certification...

Section 2 — GL Scoring Summary

GL Dimension	Value	Interpretation
Flow Success Rate (Fs)	0.30	Percentage of citizens who successfully complete the process
Strategic Value (Vn)	9.2	Importance of the policy goal (0–10)
Pain Duration (Pd)	≥100 hrs	Equivalent hours of citizen burden per interaction
Cognitive Friction (Cf)	4.5	Complexity barrier facing citizens (1–5 scale)
GL Index Score	0.006	Risk Classification: Critical Risk

GL Formula: $(Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf)$ Numerator: $0.3 \times 9.2 = 2.76$ Denominator: $100 \times 4.5 = 450.0$
 GL Index = $2.76 \div 450.0 = 0.006$

Section 3 — Citizen Objective

A teacher, nurse, or public servant who worked 10 years in qualifying employment and made 120 qualifying payments, attempting to receive the promised student loan forgiveness.

Section 4 — Friction Findings

Friction Type	Severity	Observation
Document complexity	5/5	Dozens of pages of documentation required; employer certification formats changed repeatedly
Annual recertification burden	5/5	Borrowers required to re-verify employment annually for 10 years with no confirmation of compliance
Retroactive rule changes	5/5	Repayment plan eligibility changed after borrowers had already made years of qualifying payments
Information black hole	4/5	No real-time progress tracking; servicers gave contradictory information
Legal language complexity	4/5	Terms like 'qualifying repayment plan' and 'full-time employment' had non-obvious legal definitions
Abandonment inducement	4/5	Uncertainty caused many to give up before reaching the 120-payment threshold

Section 5 — Failure Pattern Classification

- Compliance layering — rules stacked to the point of inaccessibility
- Burden transfer — borrowers responsible for tracking government data
- Dashboard illusion — program reported as 'operational' with <1% approval rate
- Vendor self-verification failure — loan servicers had conflicts of interest

Section 6 — Structural Weakness Analysis

The system was designed for lawyers, not borrowers. Eligibility rules were retroactively changed, employer certification was inconsistent, and repayment plan qualification was ambiguous — creating a bureaucratic firewall that eliminated most applicants before they could complete the process.

Section 7 — Core Diagnostic Insight

A program's legitimacy cannot be measured by its stated generosity. When the success rate is under 1%, the program has mathematically failed — regardless of how noble the intent. Complexity functions as a hidden tax that disproportionately penalizes those without legal or financial advisors.

Section 8 — Remediation Recommendations

The following remedies target the specific friction drivers identified in this diagnostic. Each remedy includes projected GL improvement based on optimized parameters.

#	Remedy	Action	Target	Projected GL
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1	Automatic Forgiveness	Integrate IRS and SSA data to automatically track qualifying payments and employer status. Trigger forgiveness automatically at 120 payments — no application required.	Fs: 0.30→0.95Pd: 100→10 hrs	≈ 2.91(+485x)
2	Retroactive Payment Validation	Legislate that any on-time payment, regardless of repayment plan at the time, counts as a qualifying payment. Eliminate retroactive disqualification.	Cf: 4.5→2.0	≈ 2.91
3	Independent Loan Ombudsman	Establish an independent office empowered to adjudicate disputes, fine servicers, and provide borrowers with real-time progress dashboards ('Payments: 98/120').	Cf: 2.0→1.5Pd: 10→2 hrs	≈ 2.91

Section 9 — Independent Conclusion

Risk Classification: Critical Risk GL Score: 0.006 This case demonstrates that policy legitimacy cannot be measured by stated intent or budget allocated. The GL Index reveals the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed on citizens during delivery. A GL below 0.5 constitutes policy violence — regardless of how noble the original objective.

GL-UK-001 United Kingdom · Social Welfare / Income Support

United Kingdom: Universal Credit

Section 1 — Executive Summary

Case ID	GL-UK-001
Country / Region	United Kingdom
Policy Evaluated	Universal Credit
Policy Domain	Social Welfare / Income Support
Period of Analysis	2013–present
GL Index Score	0.06
Risk Classification	Critical Risk
Key Structural Weakness	The system was designed assuming every applicant has the organizational capacity of a civil servant, the financial liter...

Section 2 — GL Scoring Summary

GL Dimension	Value	Interpretation
Flow Success Rate (Fs)	0.65	Percentage of citizens who successfully complete the process
Strategic Value (Vn)	7.0	Importance of the policy goal (0–10)
Pain Duration (Pd)	≥20 hrs	Equivalent hours of citizen burden per interaction
Cognitive Friction (Cf)	3.8	Complexity barrier facing citizens (1–5 scale)
GL Index Score	0.06	Risk Classification: Critical Risk

GL Formula: $(Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf)$ Numerator: $0.65 \times 7 = 4.55$ Denominator: $20 \times 3.8 = 76.0$ GL Index = $4.55 \div 76.0 = 0.06$

Section 3 — Citizen Objective

A recently unemployed person with nearly depleted savings, attempting to apply for income support to cover rent, food, and basic living expenses.

Section 4 — Friction Findings

Friction Type	Severity	Observation
Multi-week survival gap	5/5	Mandatory 5-week wait before first payment — causing food insecurity and rent arrears
Digital access requirement	5/5	Online-only application with monthly account management required — excludes elderly and digitally excluded
Document volume	4/5	Dozens of pages covering income, housing, childcare — reads like an academic compliance document
Error sensitivity	4/5	Any minor error (wrong date, wrong file format) requires restarting the entire application
Information complexity	4/5	Eligibility rules for different household types, earnings taper rates, housing costs create cognitive maze
Chronic attrition design	4/5	System doesn't break applicants instantly — it slowly drains time, patience, and dignity until they give up

Section 5 — Failure Pattern Classification

- Burden transfer — government coordination burden transferred to citizens in crisis
- Compliance layering — six legacy systems merged without simplification
- Systemic exclusion — Cf ≥ 6.0 for elderly, effectively barring access
- Mathematized indifference — complexity functions as demand management without accountability

Section 6 — Structural Weakness Analysis

The system was designed assuming every applicant has the organizational capacity of a civil servant, the financial literacy of an accountant, and the digital skills of a young adult. The mandatory 5-week wait before first payment functions as a structural barrier that eliminates the most vulnerable before they can receive help.

Section 7 — Core Diagnostic Insight

The enemy of welfare is often its delivery system. When the application process itself constitutes poverty — time poverty, cognitive poverty, dignity poverty — the system has become self-negating. High Cf is not accidental; it is frequently a design choice that controls spending by excluding the most vulnerable.

Section 8 — Remediation Recommendations

The following remedies target the specific friction drivers identified in this diagnostic. Each remedy includes projected GL improvement based on optimized parameters.

#	Remedy	Action	Target	Projected GL
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1	Emergency Advance Payment	Issue small emergency payment within 72 hours of eligibility confirmation. Eliminate the 5-week gap for all applicants facing financial crisis.	Pd: 20→4 hrs	≈ 0.68(+11x)
2	Lifeline Access Channel	24/7 telephone application service with trained specialists completing applications on behalf of callers. Community 'Application Assistance Hubs' in libraries and community centres.	Cf: ≥5.5→≤1.5 for vulnerable groups	≈ 0.68
3	Complexity Cap Legislation	Legislate that any welfare process must not exceed a maximum Cf value (2.5) for digitally disadvantaged citizens. Establish independent regulator for regular Cf stress testing.	Cf: 3.8→2.2	≈ 0.68

Section 9 — Independent Conclusion

Risk Classification: Critical Risk GL Score: 0.06 This case demonstrates that policy legitimacy cannot be measured by stated intent or budget allocated. The GL Index reveals the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed on citizens during delivery. A GL below 0.5 constitutes policy violence — regardless of how noble the original objective.

GL-TW-001 Taiwan · Public Health / Emergency Response

Taiwan: COVID-19 Vaccine Booking Platform

Section 1 — Executive Summary

Case ID	GL-TW-001
Country / Region	Taiwan
Policy Evaluated	COVID-19 Vaccine Booking Platform
Policy Domain	Public Health / Emergency Response
Period of Analysis	2021
GL Index Score	Overall: 1.50 / Elderly cohort: 0.16
Risk Classification	High Risk
Key Structural Weakness	The platform was designed for an idealized 'digital citizen' — literate, smartphone-capable, and comfortable with multi-...

Section 2 — GL Scoring Summary

GL Dimension	Value	Interpretation
Flow Success Rate (Fs)	0.70 (overall) 0.50 (elderly)	Percentage of citizens who successfully complete the process
Strategic Value (Vn)	9.0	Importance of the policy goal (0–10)
Pain Duration (Pd)	1.5 hrs avg 5+ hrs (elderly)	Equivalent hours of citizen burden per interaction
Cognitive Friction (Cf)	2.8 avg 5.5 (elderly)	Complexity barrier facing citizens (1–5 scale)
GL Index Score	Overall: 1.50 / Elderly cohort: 0.16	Risk Classification: High Risk

GL Formula: $(Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf)$
 Numerator: $0.7 \times 9 = 6.30$
 Denominator: $1.55 \times 2.8 = 4.3$
 GL Index = $6.30 \div 4.3 =$ Overall: 1.50 / Elderly cohort: 0.16

Section 3 — Citizen Objective

An elderly person aged 75+, attempting to book a COVID-19 vaccine appointment through the government's online booking platform during the peak of the pandemic, when vaccines were scarce and survival depended on timely access.

Section 4 — Friction Findings

Friction Type	Severity	Observation
Touchscreen interface inaccessibility	5/5	Small fonts, unresponsive touch controls, CAPTCHA challenges — insurmountable for many elderly users
No proxy booking functionality	5/5	No built-in way for family members to book on behalf of elderly relatives
Slot scarcity and speed requirement	5/5	Slots disappeared within seconds, requiring digital fluency and fast response that elderly users could not provide
Digital skill prerequisite	4/5	Platform assumed smartphone literacy as a baseline, excluding those without it
Limited telephone backup	4/5	1922 phone line existed but had insufficient capacity and inferior booking speed
Anxiety burden	4/5	Watching slots disappear while unable to complete booking created severe psychological pain

Section 5 — Failure Pattern Classification

- Pseudo-digitalization — technically advanced but accessibility-blind
- Reverse protection — excluded the highest-risk population from protection
- Average GL deception — overall GL of 1.5 masked elderly cohort GL of 0.16
- Digital divide amplification — existing inequality institutionalized in emergency system

Section 6 — Structural Weakness Analysis

The platform was designed for an idealized 'digital citizen' — literate, smartphone-capable, and comfortable with multi-step online processes. This design presumption created a system that functioned excellently for the young and digitally fluent, while systematically blocking the elderly — the population most in need of protection.

Section 7 — Core Diagnostic Insight

Technological neutrality is a lie. All systems embed the assumptions of their designers. An overall GL value of 1.5 conceals a catastrophic GL of 0.16 for the most vulnerable group. True legitimacy requires the GL value to be acceptable for every cohort — not just the average.

Section 8 — Remediation Recommendations

The following remedies target the specific friction drivers identified in this diagnostic. Each remedy includes projected GL improvement based on optimized parameters.

#	Remedy	Action	Target	Projected GL
1	Mandatory Elderly-First Design	'One-click proxy booking' prominently placed on homepage. Voice navigation mode for all steps. Dedicated community pharmacy terminals for assisted booking.	Cf: 5.5→2.0(elderly)	≈ 2.55(elderly cohort)
2	Age-Stratified Fair Quotas	Reserve 30% of each booking round explicitly for 65+ age group with dedicated booking windows — preventing competition with automated booking scripts.	Fs: 0.50→0.85(elderly)	≈ 2.55
3	Zero-Digital-Threshold Backup	Proactive outreach using National Health Insurance database to identify high-risk elderly. Health center staff or volunteers proactively telephone to complete booking. Home vaccination registration channel for immobile persons.	Pd: 5→1 hrCf: →1.0	≈ 2.55

Section 9 — Independent Conclusion

Risk Classification: High Risk
GL Score: Overall: 1.50 / Elderly cohort: 0.16
 This case demonstrates that policy legitimacy cannot be measured by stated intent or budget allocated. The GL Index reveals the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed on citizens during delivery. A GL below 0.5 constitutes policy violence — regardless of how noble the original objective.

GL-IN-001 India · Monetary Policy / Financial System

India: Demonetization (Withdrawal of ₹500 & ₹1000 notes)

Section 1 — Executive Summary

Case ID	GL-IN-001
Country / Region	India
Policy Evaluated	Demonetization (Withdrawal of ₹500 & ₹1000 notes)
Policy Domain	Monetary Policy / Financial System
Period of Analysis	November 2016
GL Index Score	0.023
Risk Classification	Critical Risk
Key Structural Weakness	Policymakers catastrophically underestimated the denominator. The reform treated cash exchange as a simple banking trans...

Section 2 — GL Scoring Summary

GL Dimension	Value	Interpretation
Flow Success Rate (Fs)	0.55	Percentage of citizens who successfully complete the process
Strategic Value (Vn)	8.0	Importance of the policy goal (0–10)
Pain Duration (Pd)	≥48 hrs	Equivalent hours of citizen burden per interaction
Cognitive Friction (Cf)	4.0	Complexity barrier facing citizens (1–5 scale)
GL Index Score	0.023	Risk Classification: Critical Risk

GL Formula: $(Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf)$ Numerator: $0.55 \times 8 = 4.40$ Denominator: $48 \times 4 = 192.0$
 GL Index = $4.40 \div 192.0 = 0.023$

Section 3 — Citizen Objective

An ordinary citizen — farmer, daily wage worker, small merchant — holding legal savings in cash, attempting to exchange now-invalid currency notes for valid currency within the official exchange window, in a country where 86% of cash was invalidated overnight.

Section 4 — Friction Findings

Friction Type	Severity	Observation
Physical queue burden	5/5	Millions spent entire days in bank and ATM queues; queues persisted for weeks in many areas
Unbanked population exclusion	5/5	Rural and unbanked citizens faced $C_f \geq 6.0$ — needing to open accounts, understand rules, navigate bureaucracy simultaneously
Overnight implementation shock	5/5	Zero transition period; 86% of circulating currency invalidated with hours of notice
Survival economy disruption	5/5	Daily wage workers, farmers, and small merchants could not pay or receive wages for weeks
Information inaccessibility	4/5	Rules communicated in urban-centric, digital-first formats inaccessible to rural populations
Discrimination by existing resources	4/5	Those with bank accounts, advisors, and digital access absorbed the shock; the poorest bore maximum burden

Section 5 — Failure Pattern Classification

- Catastrophic denominator underestimation — $Pd \times Cf$ impact on the poorest was not modeled
- Systemic discrimination — policy cost disproportionately transferred to bottom income quintile
- Surgery without anesthesia — radical reform without transition mechanisms
- Outcome failure — large portion of demonetized currency returned to banking system, primary anti-black-money goal not achieved

Section 6 — Structural Weakness Analysis

Policymakers catastrophically underestimated the denominator. The reform treated cash exchange as a simple banking transaction, ignoring that hundreds of millions of citizens had no bank accounts, lived far from bank branches, had no digital payment infrastructure, and depended entirely on cash for daily survival. The cost of the reform was paid almost entirely by those who could least afford it.

Section 7 — Core Diagnostic Insight

The scale of a reform does not determine its legitimacy. A policy's legitimacy depends on the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed. Financial inclusion is infrastructure, not a bonus feature — any mandatory financial policy must first ensure all citizens have low- C_f access to the financial system it depends upon.

Section 8 — Remediation Recommendations

The following remedies target the specific friction drivers identified in this diagnostic. Each remedy includes projected GL improvement based on optimized parameters.

#	Remedy	Action	Target	Projected GL
1	Phased Implementation	Three-stage demonetization over 2–3 months: large notes first, then medium, then full adjustment. Old notes remain valid in food, fuel, and medicine sectors during transition.	Pd: 48→12 hrs	≈ 0.19(+8x)
2	Emergency Financial Inclusion	Zero-threshold basic bank account program launched simultaneously with announcement. Postal network deployed as exchange and banking points. Multilingual pictorial instructions via radio and community announcements.	Cf: ≥6.0→≤2.5(vulnerable groups)	≈ 0.19
3	Real-Time Transparency Dashboard	Public dashboard showing cash inventory, queue times, and exchange success rates by location. Emergency complaint center for hospitals, food stores, and critical infrastructure facing cash shortages.	Cf psychologicalPd: uncertaintyreduction	≈ 0.19

Section 9 — Independent Conclusion

Risk Classification: Critical Risk GL Score: 0.023 This case demonstrates that policy legitimacy cannot be measured by stated intent or budget allocated. The GL Index reveals the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed on citizens during delivery. A GL below 0.5 constitutes policy violence — regardless of how noble the original objective.

GL-EU-001 European Union · Privacy / Digital Rights

European Union: General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)

Section 1 — Executive Summary

Case ID	GL-EU-001
Country / Region	European Union
Policy Evaluated	General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)
Policy Domain	Privacy / Digital Rights
Period of Analysis	2018–present
GL Index Score	≈ 0.40
Risk Classification	High Risk
Key Structural Weakness	GDPR's intent — returning data sovereignty to individuals — is undermined by its own execution design. The compliance me...

Section 2 — GL Scoring Summary

GL Dimension	Value	Interpretation
Flow Success Rate (Fs)	0.75	Percentage of citizens who successfully complete the process
Strategic Value (Vn)	8.5	Importance of the policy goal (0–10)
Pain Duration (Pd)	≥15 hrs/year	Equivalent hours of citizen burden per interaction
Cognitive Friction (Cf)	3.2	Complexity barrier facing citizens (1–5 scale)
GL Index Score	≈ 0.40	Risk Classification: High Risk

GL Formula: $(Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf)$
Numerator: $0.75 \times 8.5 = 6.38$
Denominator: $15 \times 3.2 = 48.0$
GL Index = $6.38 \div 48.0 \approx 0.40$

Section 3 — Citizen Objective

An ordinary internet user attempting to exercise their legal right to control personal data, or a small business owner attempting to comply with data protection requirements without a dedicated legal team.

Section 4 — Friction Findings

Friction Type	Severity	Observation
Consent fatigue	4/5	Repeated cookie consent banners on every new website visit create conditioned reflex of blind acceptance
Legal language inaccessibility	4/5	Privacy policies are written for lawyers, not users — genuine informed consent is rarely achievable
SME compliance burden	5/5	Understanding and implementing GDPR requires expensive legal consultation that small businesses cannot afford
Dark pattern exploitation	4/5	Large companies use interface design to make 'Accept All' visually dominant while 'Reject' options are hidden
Persistent micro-pain	3/5	Cumulative annual time lost to consent decisions and preference management across all digital interactions
Geographic discrimination	3/5	Some services block EU users entirely rather than comply — reducing citizen access to digital services

Section 5 — Failure Pattern Classification

- High Vn, collapsed Fs — noble goal undermined by inaccessible execution
- Compliance externalization — regulatory costs transferred to individuals and small businesses
- Consent theater — users click 'Accept' without exercising genuine choice
- Regulatory capture benefit — large platforms absorb compliance costs; small competitors cannot

Section 6 — Structural Weakness Analysis

GDPR's intent — returning data sovereignty to individuals — is undermined by its own execution design. The compliance mechanism (cookie consent banners, privacy policy walls) creates 'consent fatigue' that causes users to abandon informed decision-making. The law's complexity means it disproportionately burdens small businesses while large technology companies with legal teams are better positioned to navigate — and sometimes exploit — its ambiguities.

Section 7 — Core Diagnostic Insight

The weight of a right depends on the friction required to exercise it. A right granted by law but inaccessible in practice has low real-world value. Good regulation should reduce total societal transaction costs — not simply shift them from corporations to individuals. Technical standards are more effective enforcers of legal intent than behavioral compliance requirements.

Section 8 — Remediation Recommendations

The following remedies target the specific friction drivers identified in this diagnostic. Each remedy includes projected GL improvement based on optimized parameters.

#	Remedy	Action	Target	Projected GL
1	Global Privacy Preference Standard	Browser and OS-level privacy settings that websites automatically read and obey — no per-visit banners. Users set preferences once; sites comply automatically. Standardized graphical privacy labels like nutrition labels.	Pd: 15→0.5 hrs/yrCf: 3.5→1.5	≈ 3.61(+9x)
2	SME Compliance Toolkit	EU-provided free online compliance generator with Q&A interface auto-generating compliant documents. Open-source code modules for consent management. Simplified filing regime for micro-enterprises.	Cf: 4.5→2.0(SME cohort)	≈ 3.61
3	Dark Pattern Prohibition	Heavy fines for interface designs that hide rejection options or use color/size to mislead. Official 'Privacy by Default' certification label for high-privacy products. Market incentive alignment.	Fs: 0.75→0.85actual consent quality	≈ 3.61

Section 9 — Independent Conclusion

Risk Classification: High Risk GL Score: ≈ 0.40 This case demonstrates that policy legitimacy cannot be measured by stated intent or budget allocated. The GL Index reveals the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed on citizens during delivery. A GL below 0.5 constitutes policy violence — regardless of how noble the original objective.

GL-JP-001 Japan · Digital Identity / Administrative Integration

Japan: My Number Card (Individual Number Card System)

Section 1 — Executive Summary

Case ID	GL-JP-001
Country / Region	Japan
Policy Evaluated	My Number Card (Individual Number Card System)
Policy Domain	Digital Identity / Administrative Integration
Period of Analysis	2016–present
GL Index Score	Overall: ~0.90 / Acquisition hurdle: 0.15
Risk Classification	High Risk
Key Structural Weakness	The system failed not technically but socially. The government presented a digital identity card without winning public ...

Section 2 — GL Scoring Summary

GL Dimension	Value	Interpretation
Flow Success Rate (Fs)	0.60	Percentage of citizens who successfully complete the process
Strategic Value (Vn)	7.5	Importance of the policy goal (0–10)
Pain Duration (Pd)	≥6 hrs	Equivalent hours of citizen burden per interaction
Cognitive Friction (Cf)	3.5	Complexity barrier facing citizens (1–5 scale)
GL Index Score	Overall: ~0.90 / Acquisition hurdle: 0.15	Risk Classification: High Risk

GL Formula: $(Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf)$ Numerator: $0.6 \times 7.5 = 4.50$ Denominator: $6 \times 3.5 = 21.0$
 GL Index = $4.50 \div 21.0 =$ Overall: ~0.90 / Acquisition hurdle: 0.15

Section 3 — Citizen Objective

An ordinary Japanese citizen — particularly outside the early-adopter demographic — attempting to understand the value of the My Number Card, decide whether to apply, and navigate the multi-step in-person application and collection process.

Section 4 — Friction Findings

Friction Type	Severity	Observation
Value proposition opacity	4/5	Overlaps with existing IDs (driver's license, health insurance card) — no compelling unique benefit communicated
Trust deficit	5/5	Historical privacy concerns and fear of government data centralization create powerful psychological barrier
Multi-step in-person requirement	4/5	Application requires in-person visit; card collection requires second in-person visit — significant time commitment
Document preparation burden	3/5	Requires notification card, photo ID, and specific photograph format with strict requirements
Psychological friction	4/5	Uncertainty about data use, surveillance implications, and security create sustained anxiety cost
Utility gap	3/5	Promised uses (convenience store photocopies, etc.) failed to create genuine daily-life relevance

Section 5 — Failure Pattern Classification

- Trust-value prepayment failure — citizens asked to pay upfront with time and privacy for uncertain future benefit
- Acquisition hurdle GL collapse — overall GL of ~0.90 masks acquisition GL of 0.15
- Coercion-convenience paradox — mandatory elements reduced voluntary adoption
- Digital social contract failure — technology without public trust negotiation

Section 6 — Structural Weakness Analysis

The system failed not technically but socially. The government presented a digital identity card without winning public trust on data sovereignty, without offering compelling immediate value over existing ID documents, and without reducing the acquisition friction to a level where the perceived benefit exceeded the perceived cost and risk. The 'why do I need this?' barrier was never resolved.

Section 7 — Core Diagnostic Insight

The core of digital identity is a social contract, not a technical specification. Citizens will voluntarily adopt digital systems only when the perceived immediate value clearly exceeds the perceived privacy cost and friction of acquisition. Convenience is the greatest driver; transparency is the hardest currency. The acquisition hurdle GL must be managed separately from the overall system GL.

Section 8 — Remediation Recommendations

The following remedies target the specific friction drivers identified in this diagnostic. Each remedy includes projected GL improvement based on optimized parameters.

#	Remedy	Action	Target	Projected GL
1	Super App Integration	Stop promoting 'another card.' Integrate My Number App to completely replace health insurance card, driver's license authentication, library card. Bind to high-frequency services: transit passes, convenience store payment. Deploy privacy-enhancing technology (zero-knowledge proof).	Perceived Vn: 6→8 Value Cf: reduced	≈ 5.76(acquisition)
2	Home Delivery Application	'Postman to Home' service: citizens schedule online, postal staff visit with mobile device, complete application in 10 minutes. Card mailed to home. Eliminate both in-person visits.	Pd: 6→0.5 hrs	≈ 5.76
3	Transparent Data Contract	Ultra-simplified graphical 'Data Use Pledge' clearly stating when, why, and how government uses My Number data. Independent data oversight body with public reporting. Strong penalties and publicized cases for misuse.	Trust Cf: 1.5→0.5	≈ 5.76

Section 9 — Independent Conclusion

Risk Classification: High Risk
GL Score: Overall: ~0.90 / Acquisition hurdle: 0.15
 This case demonstrates that policy legitimacy cannot be measured by stated intent or budget allocated. The GL Index reveals the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed on citizens during delivery. A GL below 0.5 constitutes policy violence — regardless of how noble the original objective.

GL-ZA-001 South Africa · Social Welfare / Income Support

South Africa: Social Grant Payment System (SASSA)

Section 1 — Executive Summary

Case ID	GL-ZA-001
Country / Region	South Africa
Policy Evaluated	Social Grant Payment System (SASSA)
Policy Domain	Social Welfare / Income Support
Period of Analysis	Ongoing
GL Index Score	0.066–0.71 (volatile)
Risk Classification	Critical Risk
Key Structural Weakness	The most dangerous failure is not a consistently low GL value — it is an unpredictably volatile one. A system that somet...

Section 2 — GL Scoring Summary

GL Dimension	Value	Interpretation
Flow Success Rate (Fs)	0.50–0.90 (volatile)	Percentage of citizens who successfully complete the process
Strategic Value (Vn)	9.5	Importance of the policy goal (0–10)
Pain Duration (Pd)	≥8 hrs/month	Equivalent hours of citizen burden per interaction
Cognitive Friction (Cf)	3.5	Complexity barrier facing citizens (1–5 scale)
GL Index Score	0.066–0.71 (volatile)	Risk Classification: Critical Risk

GL Formula: $(Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf)$
 Numerator: $0.5 \times 9.5 = 4.75$
 Denominator: $8 \times 3.5 = 28.0$
 GL Index = $4.75 \div 28.0 = 0.066–0.71$ (volatile)

Section 3 — Citizen Objective

One of 18 million South Africans dependent on government social grants — including old-age pensions, child support grants, and disability grants — attempting to receive their monthly payment on payout day.

Section 4 — Friction Findings

Friction Type	Severity	Observation
System failure unpredictability	5/5	Payment system fails without warning — ATM cash shortages, network outages, card deactivations — with no advance notice
Single point of failure dependency	5/5	Entire system routed through one private provider — failure of one entity affects 18 million people simultaneously
Survival-level stakes	5/5	Failure to receive payment means no food, no medicine, no rent — every failure day is a humanitarian event
Information vacuum during failures	4/5	No real-time system status; official explanations vague or contradictory; recipients cannot determine if/when to retry
Dignity cost of public failure	4/5	Repeated failed attempts at payment terminals in public view erodes dignity and creates learned helplessness
Complaint channel inaccessibility	4/5	Helplines unreachable during failures; on-site staff lack authority to resolve issues

Section 5 — Failure Pattern Classification

- Single point of failure — entire system dependent on one private contractor
- Stability failure — volatility is more harmful than consistent underperformance
- Information black hole — system status opaque to recipients during failures
- Legitimacy outsourcing — governance accountability delegated to private entity's risk management

Section 6 — Structural Weakness Analysis

The most dangerous failure is not a consistently low GL value — it is an unpredictably volatile one. A system that sometimes works and sometimes fails is more harmful to 18 million survival-dependent recipients than a consistently lower-quality system, because it destroys predictability, amplifies anxiety, and leaves citizens unable to plan. The single-provider dependency creates catastrophic systemic fragility.

Section 7 — Core Diagnostic Insight

For survival-level policies, stability is more important than average efficiency. System redundancy is infrastructure of legitimacy. Real-time transparency is the cheapest and most effective social stabilizer. When 18 million lives depend on a system, its design must prioritize preventing worst-case outcomes over optimizing average-case efficiency.

Section 8 — Remediation Recommendations

The following remedies target the specific friction drivers identified in this diagnostic. Each remedy includes projected GL improvement based on optimized parameters.

#	Remedy	Action	Target	Projected GL
1	Multi-Provider Parallel Architecture	Divide recipients across at least three independent providers simultaneously. Failure of one provider affects at most one-third of recipients. Automatic failover routes affected recipients to backup provider via SMS notification.	Fs volatility:0.50-0.90 → stable 0.90	≈ 2.14(stable)
2	Digital Wallet Direct Deposit	Grant payments deposited directly to mobile wallets. Extensive agent network at spaza shops and fuel stations for small cash withdrawals without queuing. Emergency food voucher QR codes auto-sent during extended system failures.	Pd: 8→2 hrs	≈ 2.14
3	Recipient Rights Ombudsman	Independent office directly accountable to parliament, empowered to investigate providers and mandate compensation. One-button USSD/SMS help with guaranteed response time. Community navigator program.	Cf: 3.5→2.0	≈ 2.14

Section 9 — Independent Conclusion

Risk Classification: Critical Risk GL Score: 0.066–0.71 (volatile) This case demonstrates that policy legitimacy cannot be measured by stated intent or budget allocated. The GL Index reveals the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed on citizens during delivery. A GL below 0.5 constitutes policy violence — regardless of how noble the original objective.

GL-AU-001 Australia · Emergency Response / Disaster Relief

Australia: Flood Disaster Relief Grants

Section 1 — Executive Summary

Case ID	GL-AU-001
Country / Region	Australia
Policy Evaluated	Flood Disaster Relief Grants
Policy Domain	Emergency Response / Disaster Relief
Period of Analysis	2022 Eastern Australia Floods
GL Index Score	0.078
Risk Classification	Critical Risk
Key Structural Weakness	The application system was designed for peacetime administration and deployed without modification in a disaster context...

Section 2 — GL Scoring Summary

GL Dimension	Value	Interpretation
Flow Success Rate (Fs)	0.40	Percentage of citizens who successfully complete the process
Strategic Value (Vn)	9.8	Importance of the policy goal (0–10)
Pain Duration (Pd)	≥12 hrs	Equivalent hours of citizen burden per interaction
Cognitive Friction (Cf)	4.2	Complexity barrier facing citizens (1–5 scale)
GL Index Score	0.078	Risk Classification: Critical Risk

GL Formula: $(Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf)$ Numerator: $0.4 \times 9.8 = 3.92$ Denominator: $12 \times 4.2 = 50.4$ GL Index = $3.92 \div 50.4 = 0.078$

Section 3 — Citizen Objective

A flood victim who has just lost their home and livelihood, attempting to apply for emergency government relief grants to cover immediate survival needs — food, shelter, and basic necessities — while their home may still be underwater and their documents, devices, and digital access may have been destroyed.

Section 4 — Friction Findings

Friction Type	Severity	Observation
Prove-your-disaster paradox	5/5	Required before/after photos and specific documents — destroyed by the same flood the applicant was trying to prove
Technology access assumption	5/5	Online-only application when phones, computers, and internet were destroyed or inaccessible
System overload at peak need	5/5	Government websites crashed under demand exactly when most urgently needed
Cognitive capacity mismatch	5/5	Complex eligibility forms required sustained cognitive engagement from traumatized, sleep-deprived disaster victims
Document gathering in chaos	4/5	Collecting required documents (specific bank statements, deeds, property records) from destroyed or flooded premises
Information contradictions	4/5	Different channels (website, hotline, evacuation centers) gave conflicting information about eligibility and process

Section 5 — Failure Pattern Classification

- Disaster-context blindness — peacetime system deployed unchanged in emergency
- Prove-your-crisis burden — victims required to document their own disaster in real time
- Technology dependency in infrastructure failure — online system when infrastructure was destroyed
- Secondary injury — the relief process became an additional source of harm

Section 6 — Structural Weakness Analysis

The application system was designed for peacetime administration and deployed without modification in a disaster context. It required citizens who were traumatized, without devices, without documents, and without stable internet access to navigate a complex online application process — creating a secondary disaster on top of the primary one.

Section 7 — Core Diagnostic Insight

Disaster policy must presume citizen capacity paralysis. Any design requiring complex tasks or time-consuming processes from disaster victims is inherently immoral. The GL formula for disaster response must target $P_d \rightarrow 0$, $C_f \rightarrow 1$. Good data use is the most efficient humanitarianism — government data about who lives where should automatically trigger relief, not require citizens to prove what the government already knows.

Section 8 — Remediation Recommendations

The following remedies target the specific friction drivers identified in this diagnostic. Each remedy includes projected GL improvement based on optimized parameters.

#	Remedy	Action	Target	Projected GL
1	Geography-Based Automatic Eligibility	When government declares a postal code a disaster zone, all registered welfare, pension, and disability recipients in that zone automatically receive emergency advance payment within 24 hours — no application. Satellite imagery and AI identify damaged structures; occupants auto-added to grant list.	Fs: 0.40→0.95Pd: 12→~0 hrs	≈ 6.21(+80x)
2	On-Site Disaster Response Envoys	Deploy government-empowered envoys to every evacuation center with authority to verify identity orally, confirm loss verbally, and approve emergency grants immediately via mobile device. No forms. No documents. Immediate payment.	Cf: 4.2→1.5	≈ 6.21
3	Pre-Disaster Resilience Database	Peacetime opt-in registration allowing government to pre-authenticate citizens for rapid disaster deployment. Secure cross-agency data linkage for rapid eligibility verification. Annual public stress tests simulating disaster scenarios.	Baseline Fs/Cfimprovement for future disasters	≈ 6.21

Section 9 — Independent Conclusion

Risk Classification: Critical Risk GL Score: 0.078 This case demonstrates that policy legitimacy cannot be measured by stated intent or budget allocated. The GL Index reveals the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed on citizens during delivery. A GL below 0.5 constitutes policy violence — regardless of how noble the original objective.

GL-CA-001 Canada · Identity / Consular Services

Canada: Passport Renewal Service

Section 1 — Executive Summary

Case ID	GL-CA-001
Country / Region	Canada
Policy Evaluated	Passport Renewal Service
Policy Domain	Identity / Consular Services
Period of Analysis	2022–2023 (Crisis Peak)
GL Index Score	0.032
Risk Classification	Critical Risk
Key Structural Weakness	The system failed not from an unforeseeable shock but from foreseeable, preventable inaction. The government had data on...

Section 2 — GL Scoring Summary

GL Dimension	Value	Interpretation
Flow Success Rate (Fs)	0.75	Percentage of citizens who successfully complete the process
Strategic Value (Vn)	8.0	Importance of the policy goal (0–10)
Pain Duration (Pd)	≥50 hrs	Equivalent hours of citizen burden per interaction
Cognitive Friction (Cf)	3.8	Complexity barrier facing citizens (1–5 scale)
GL Index Score	0.032	Risk Classification: Critical Risk

GL Formula: $(Fs \times Vn) \div (Pd \times Cf)$ Numerator: $0.75 \times 8 = 6.00$ Denominator: $50 \times 3.8 = 190.0$ GL Index = $6.00 \div 190.0 = 0.032$

Section 3 — Citizen Objective

A Canadian citizen with an expired or expiring passport, attempting to renew in time for essential international travel — whether for a family emergency, a work contract, or a planned trip — after pandemic travel restrictions lifted and demand surged across the entire population simultaneously.

Section 4 — Friction Findings

Friction Type	Severity	Observation
Processing time explosion	5/5	Standard weeks-long processing expanded to months with no reliable estimate or guarantee
Telephone inaccessibility	5/5	Call center wait times of hours or complete unavailability — information black hole during crisis
Physical queue camping	5/5	Hundreds queued overnight outside offices with no guaranteed service upon reaching the front
Uncertainty-driven anxiety	5/5	Unable to plan travel, business, or family arrangements while waiting months for unknown outcome
Path choice confusion	4/5	Mail vs. in-person vs. expedited options had unclear rules, inconsistent fees, and unreliable time estimates
Forced expedite fees	4/5	Many citizens forced to pay significant premium fees or travel to distant offices — wealth-based two-tier access

Section 5 — Failure Pattern Classification

- Foreseeable crisis treated as unforeseeable — government had all data needed to predict surge
- Time expectation collapse — reasonable expectation of routine service fundamentally violated
- Information black hole — real-time processing data not publicly available during crisis
- Elastic capacity failure — system designed for normal demand with no surge mechanism

Section 6 — Structural Weakness Analysis

The system failed not from an unforeseeable shock but from foreseeable, preventable inaction. The government had data on every expired passport in Canada and could fully model the post-pandemic demand surge. The failure to proactively scale capacity before demand arrived — combined with an information opacity that left applicants unable to plan — constitutes a fundamental governance failure of prediction and preparation.

Section 7 — Core Diagnostic Insight

A foreseeable crisis is a preventable crisis. The government had all the data required to predict the post-pandemic passport surge months in advance. Public service legitimacy has a time expectation threshold — when wait times far exceed reasonable expectation, GL collapses regardless of ultimate success. Transparency about real-time status is the most cost-effective intervention available.

Section 8 — Remediation Recommendations

The following remedies target the specific friction drivers identified in this diagnostic. Each remedy includes projected GL improvement based on optimized parameters.

#	Remedy	Action	Target	Projected GL
1	Demand Forecasting & Elastic Capacity	System automatically monitors passport expiry data and forecasts renewal peaks 6–12 months ahead. Proactively triggers temporary staff hiring, training, and processing center setup. Dynamic appointment booking showing real-time availability and processing time estimates.	Pd: 50→4 hrsFs: stable 0.95	≈ 1.06(+33x)
2	One-Stop Digital Application Manager	Smart online form with built-in photo compliance check and document validation before submission. Personalized progress dashboard with clear stages and estimated completion date. AI chatbot handling common questions with escalation to human service within 15 minutes.	Cf: 3.8→1.8	≈ 1.06
3	Automatic Renewal for Low-Risk Applicants	Adults with stable personal information and clean passport history receive 'One-Click Confirm Renewal' option 6 months before expiry. Online identity verification triggers automatic processing and mail delivery — no office visits required. Service level commitment with automatic compensation for government-caused delays.	Pd: 50→~0 hrsfor eligible cohort	≈ 1.06+

Section 9 — Independent Conclusion

Risk Classification: Critical Risk GL Score: 0.032 This case demonstrates that policy legitimacy cannot be measured by stated intent or budget allocated. The GL Index reveals the ratio between value delivered and pain imposed on citizens during delivery. A GL below 0.5 constitutes policy violence — regardless of how noble the original objective.